

Comprehensive Salary Architecture and Placement Performance of the CUSAT BTech Program

Executive Summary

The Cochin University of Science and Technology (CUSAT) represents a leading state-funded technical institution within India's higher education landscape, holding an National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC) A+ grade and securing the 55th rank in the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) 2025 Engineering category.¹ A primary metric of its institutional efficacy is the performance of its Bachelor of Technology (BTech) programs in campus recruitment drives.

An examination of recruitment metrics reveals a highly stable placement ecosystem, though one characterized by sharp divergence between specialized niche disciplines and traditional core or circuit branches.⁴ While overall university placement rates consistently range between 75% and 90% across departments⁴, the economic value of these placements—reflected in the average, median, and highest salary packages—is heavily influenced by macroeconomic trends, student specialization, and campus location.⁶

The institutional placement data demonstrates that while the highest domestic compensation package has remained structurally stable around the INR 20.00 LPA to INR 29.83 LPA range⁴, the average salary package for BTech graduates fluctuates between INR 5.40 LPA and INR 7.32 LPA depending on the specific academic cycle and tracking agency.⁴ This document provides a comparative analysis of the BTech salary packages, evaluates historical trajectories, details branch-wise discrepancies, analyzes campus division divergences between the main Thrikkakara and Kuttanad campuses, and maps the recruiting corporate landscape.⁶

Comparative Analysis of BTech Salary Benchmarks

A rigorous evaluation of CUSAT's BTech salary structure requires reconciling data from multiple reporting channels, including the NIRF institutional reports, centralized placement office logs, department-specific reports, and media releases.⁴ Public media releases frequently present an aggregated view of campus-wide hiring that blends undergraduate, postgraduate, and professional management degrees.¹⁰ This often creates a variance between the reported "overall university average" and the actual "BTech-specific median" and average packages.⁴ For example, media-compiled placement reports for the 2024 graduating class highlighted an average package of INR 7.32 LPA, with over 700 job offers generated across 75 recruiters.¹⁰ Conversely, institutional course-wise audits indicated that the actual average package specifically within the BTech program was approximately INR 6.10 LPA.⁴ Similarly, overall university statistics for 2025 show an average salary of INR 5.40 LPA, reflecting a general contraction in entry-level hiring.⁶

The table below outlines the core BTech placement indicators over recent academic cycles,

documenting the variance across official institutional filings and validated student recruitment logs.

Academic Year	BTech Average Salary Package (LPA)	BTech Median Salary Package (LPA)	Overall University Average (LPA)	Highest Salary Package (LPA)	Total Campus Selections (All Courses)	Core Data Source
2024–25 (Ongoing)	INR 5.40 ⁶	INR 6.00 ⁶	INR 5.40 ⁶	INR 20.00 ⁶	615 ⁶	NIRF 2026 / CUSAT Kochi Placements ⁶
2023–24	INR 6.10 ⁴ / INR 6.70 ¹³ / INR 7.32 ¹⁰	INR 7.70 ⁴	INR 6.70 ⁶	INR 25.00 ⁴ / INR 29.83 ⁹	794 ⁶	NIRF 2025 / Media Reports ⁴
2022–23	INR 5.42 ⁴ / INR 5.88 ¹⁴	INR 6.00 ⁴	INR 6.54 ⁶	INR 25.00 ⁴	809 ⁶	NIRF 2025 / Course Audit ⁴
2021–22	INR 5.60 ⁴	INR 5.72 ⁴	INR 5.73 ⁶	INR 25.00 ⁴	1168 ⁶	NIRF 2025 / Year-Wise Database ⁴
2020–21	INR 4.90 ⁴	INR 4.50 ⁴	INR 5.06 ⁶	INR 25.00 ⁴	597 ⁶	NIRF 2024 / Historical Audits ⁴

The variation in these figures is driven by structural shifts in the recruiting market. The peak selection volume of 1,168 in 2022 was heavily dominated by IT-service mass recruiters.⁴ As global tech hiring slowed down through 2024 and 2025, the total volume of selections

contracted to 794 and 615 respectively.⁶ This reduction in tech-sector volume allowed core engineering, safety, and marine specialized roles—which maintain lower student intakes but offer higher starting salaries—to exert a stronger influence on the median and average salary metrics.⁴

Historical Salary Trends and Institutional Progression

A long-term assessment of CUSAT's BTech placement metrics reveals a steady upward progression in entry-level salaries, followed by a minor correction during the 2024–25 cycle.⁴ This progression is documented in the historical 4-year undergraduate (UG 4-Year) placement reports submitted to the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF).⁴ The median salary package for 4-year BTech graduates rose from INR 4.50 LPA in the 2020–21 academic year to INR 5.72 LPA in 2021–22.⁴ This was followed by a further rise to INR 6.00 LPA in 2022–23.⁴ The upward trend peaked in 2023–24, with the median salary reaching INR 7.70 LPA.⁴ During this peak cycle, out of 155 graduating students registered under the primary 4-year track, 151 successfully secured placements, representing a 97.4% employment rate among active participants.⁴ However, the 2024–25 cycle showed the impact of broader economic headwinds.⁶ According to NIRF data, the median package adjusted back to INR 6.00 LPA, with the total number of placed BTech students under this track settling at 91 out of 134 graduates.⁶ This adjustment reflects a highly selective corporate recruitment climate, prompting a larger segment of the graduating cohort to defer immediate entry into the labor market. This trend is supported by a notable rise in students opting for higher studies, which climbed from just 2 students in 2022–23 to 11 students in 2024–25.¹⁰

Specialized Branch Analysis and Compensation Gradients

The defining feature of CUSAT's placement architecture is the substantial salary and recruitment rate disparity among its engineering specializations.⁴ While mainstream branches are subject to broader market cycles, specialized departments—specifically Safety and Fire Engineering, Marine Engineering, and Naval Architecture and Shipbuilding—maintain a distinct premium.⁹ The table below provides a detailed branch-wise breakdown of BTech placement metrics for the 2025 graduating class, compiled by the KSU CUSAT Student Helpdesk.¹¹ The data represents active placement outcomes recorded as of May 31, 2025, and is organized in descending order of placement percentage.¹¹

BTech Specialization &	Registered Cohort	Eligible Students	Students Placed	Core Placements	Highest Package (LPA)	Branch Placement Rate	Estimated Average
------------------------	-------------------	-------------------	-----------------	-----------------	-----------------------	-----------------------	-------------------

Campus Division						(%)	Salary Range (LPA)
Safety and Fire Engineering (SOE)	70	66	66	66	INR 22.00 ¹¹	100.00 % ¹¹	INR 6.00 – 7.50 ⁸
Marine Engineering (KMSME)	64	47	47	47	INR 7.20 ¹¹	100.00 % ¹¹	INR 6.00 – 6.26 ¹⁴
Naval Architecture & Ship Building (DST)	24	24	24	24	INR 29.83 ⁹	100.00 % ¹¹	INR 8.30 – 9.79 ⁹
Instrumentation & Control Engineering (SOE)	25	14	13	9	INR 11.00 ¹¹	92.85% ¹¹	INR 5.00 – 6.00 ⁸
Computer Science & Engineering (SOE)	112	96	77	74	INR 15.00 ¹¹	80.20% ¹¹	INR 6.50 – 7.50 ⁸

Mechanical Engineering (SOE)	90	46	34	21	INR 6.50 ¹¹	73.91% ¹¹	INR 5.00 – 6.00 ⁸
Electrical & Electronics Engineering (SOE)	61	30	22	7	INR 7.50 ¹¹	73.33% ¹¹	INR 5.00 – 6.00 ⁸
Information Technology (CUCE K - Kuttanad)	25	25	14	14	INR 8.00 ¹¹	56.00% ¹¹	INR 4.00 – 6.00 ¹⁰
Information Technology (SOE)	113	101	52	49	INR 8.00 ¹¹	51.48% ¹¹	INR 6.00 – 7.00 ⁸
Electronics & Communication Engg (SOE)	107	58	29	8	INR 14.00 ¹¹	50.00% ¹¹	INR 5.50 – 6.50 ⁸
Computer Science &	56	45	21	17	INR 8.00 ¹¹	46.66% ¹¹	INR 4.00 – 6.00 ¹⁰

Engineering (CUCE K)							
Civil Engineering (SOE)	106	50	20	19	INR 14.00 ¹¹	40.00% ¹¹	INR 4.50 – 5.50 ⁸
Electronics & Communication Engg (CUCE K)	14	14	4	0	INR 4.00 ¹¹	28.57% ¹¹	INR 3.50 – 4.50 ¹⁰
Polymer Science & Engineering (PSRT)	19	12	1	1	INR 4.50 ¹¹	8.33% ¹¹	~INR 4.50 ¹¹

BTech in Safety and Fire Engineering

First established in 1996 as a pioneering academic initiative in India, this program is accredited by the National Board of Accreditation (NBA) under Tier 1 and recognized by the Board of Certified Safety Professionals (BCSP), USA.¹⁶ This strong regulatory alignment translates into high market demand, enabling a consistent 100% placement rate for eligible graduates.¹¹

The program's average package ranges from INR 6.00 LPA to INR 7.50 LPA, with top-tier PSU and core multinational offers (e.g., GAIL, BPCL, Reliance, and Vedanta) reaching INR 10.00 LPA to INR 22.00 LPA.⁸

BTech in Naval Architecture and Shipbuilding

Administered by the Department of Ship Technology, this program has maintained a near-perfect placement record (95% to 100%) for 45 consecutive graduating batches.⁹ Due to a curriculum that combines marine engineering design and modern shipbuilding, graduates are

highly sought after by global shipyards, offshore design consultancies, and maritime classification societies.⁹

For the 2024 batch, the average annual package stood at INR 9.79 LPA, with the highest domestic offer reaching INR 29.83 LPA.⁹ This represents a notable rise from the previous year's average of INR 8.30 LPA and highest of INR 17.30 LPA.⁹

BTech in Marine Engineering

Offered through the Kunjali Marakkar School of Marine Engineering (KMSME), this program prepares students for cadet and 5th engineer roles on commercial vessels.¹⁴ The program maintains a 100% placement rate for backlog-free candidates, with recruitment heavily driven by major global shipping lines like Maersk, Synergy Marine Group, and Fleet Management Limited.¹⁴

The starting stipend or salary generally begins at approximately USD 600 to 700 per month (about INR 50,000 per month or INR 6.00 LPA).¹⁴ This base scales rapidly to tax-free international salary structures (reaching an equivalent of INR 58.70 LPA) as cadets clear Ministry of Shipping examinations to obtain higher competency certificates.²⁰

Circuit versus Core Engineering Disciplines

The traditional circuit branches (Computer Science and Information Technology) at the School of Engineering (SOE) main campus command consistent entry-level packages averaging between INR 6.50 LPA and INR 7.50 LPA.⁸ Conversely, core engineering branches present a different placement dynamic. Mechanical and Civil Engineering show lower placement rates (73.91% and 40.00% respectively in 2025).¹¹

Because fewer core manufacturing or civil infrastructure firms conduct direct on-campus recruitment at state universities, many of these students transition into general IT consulting or operations roles with mass recruiters like TCS, Infosys, and Cognizant, which offer packages between INR 3.50 LPA and INR 5.50 LPA.⁴

Campus Division Divergences: SOE Kochi versus CUCEK Kuttanad

A major regional factor in CUSAT's placement profile is the systemic performance gap between the primary School of Engineering (SOE) on the main Thrikkakara campus in Kochi and the Cochin University College of Engineering, Kuttanad (CUCEK) in Pulinkunnu, Alappuzha.⁷ While both divisions are coordinated by the central placement office, geographic, infrastructural, and logistical realities create a bifurcated recruitment experience for students.⁷

The Kuttanad campus suffers from a lack of critical laboratory facilities for core branches like Civil and Mechanical Engineering, which directly limits hands-on preparedness and discourages core engineering companies from holding recruitment drives there.⁴ This infrastructure gap is reflected in parallel branch placement statistics for the Class of 2025 ¹¹:

- **Computer Science and Engineering (CSE):** The main SOE campus achieved an 80.20% placement rate (77 placed out of 96 eligible) with a maximum package of INR

15.00 LPA.¹¹ In contrast, CUCEK's CSE department recorded only a 46.66% placement rate (21 placed out of 45 eligible), with the highest package capped at INR 8.00 LPA.¹¹

- **Information Technology (IT):** SOE's IT branch placed 51.48% of its eligible cohort (52 out of 101)¹¹, while CUCEK's IT program placed 56.00% but within a significantly smaller cohort (14 out of 25 eligible).¹¹
- **Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE):** SOE's ECE program placed 50.00% of its students with packages up to INR 14.00 LPA.¹¹ Conversely, CUCEK's ECE division placed only 4 out of 14 eligible graduates (28.57%), with zero core industry placements and a maximum package of just INR 4.00 LPA.¹¹

Furthermore, CUCEK's independent placement metrics demonstrate a distinct and lower historical trajectory compared to the university's aggregated figures.¹⁰ The historical average packages specifically audited for the Kuttanad campus over successive cycles are detailed below¹²:

Academic Cycle (CUCEK)	Total Students Placed	Highest Package (LPA)	CUCEK Average Package (LPA)	Participating Recruiters	Core Campus Reference
2023–24	245	INR 18.00	INR 6.50	152	CUCEK Placement Portal ¹²
2022–23	230	INR 16.00	INR 6.20	145	CUCEK Placement Portal ¹²
2021–22	218	INR 15.00	INR 5.80	138	CUCEK Placement Portal ¹²

While the central university placement portal ensures that CUCEK students can technically apply for visiting recruiters, corporate hiring teams show a clear preference for the main Kochi campus.⁷ This is due to superior laboratory infrastructure, simplified logistics, and a higher concentration of elite candidates, which systematically limits the average compensation packages secured by Kuttanad graduates.⁴

Market Force Analysis and Recruiter Landscapes

The structural trends governing CUSAT's placement salary packages are driven by three main factors: recruitment by Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs), structured internship pipelines, and the composition of private-sector recruiters.⁴

Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) and Core Industry Compensation

Unlike many private technical institutions, CUSAT's state-university status and specialized marine and safety programs attract major Indian PSUs.¹⁶ These organizations offer highly competitive compensation packages that elevate the upper limit of the university's average salary metrics.

The table below outlines the primary PSU and core industrial organizations that recruit from CUSAT, along with their typical starting compensation packages.⁴

Core Recruiter	Compensation Package (CTC)	Targeted BTech Specialization	Recruiting Category
GAIL (Gas Authority of India Ltd.)	INR 17.40 LPA ⁴	Safety & Fire, Mechanical	Public Sector Undertaking ¹⁶
BPCL (Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.)	INR 17.34 LPA ⁴	Safety & Fire, Chemical, Mechanical	Public Sector Undertaking ¹⁶
ONGC (Oil and Natural Gas Corporation)	INR 14.20 LPA ⁴	Marine, Safety, Mechanical	Public Sector Undertaking ¹⁸
IOCL (Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.)	INR 12.00 LPA ⁴	Safety & Fire, Electrical	Public Sector Undertaking ¹⁶
Federal Bank	INR 9.20 LPA ⁴	Circuit Branches, ECE	Banking Sector ⁸

The Internship-to-Placement Pipeline

A key driver of high starting salaries at CUSAT is the conversion of mandatory summer internships into Pre-Placement Offers (PPOs).¹⁰ For example, students in Safety and Fire Engineering regularly undergo structured internships at highly complex industrial facilities, such as the Reliance refinery in Jamnagar, Gujarat.¹⁰

These internships often transition into full-time roles starting at INR 10.00 LPA or more.¹⁰ In the Naval Architecture program, third-year students secure internships with stipends of INR 20,000 to INR 98,000 per month at domestic and international shipyards (including Drydocks Dubai and Cochin Shipyard), which serve as direct pipelines for conversion to high-value permanent roles.⁵

Private Sector Recruiter Composition

CUSAT's recruitment network includes over 150 software, core engineering, and consulting firms.⁸ Premium technical employers like Cisco, SAP, Oracle, and Amazon offer BTech packages ranging from INR 12.00 LPA to INR 25.00 LPA.⁴

However, the volume of placements is anchored by large-scale IT service providers and multinational consultancies, including TCS, Accenture, IBM, Cognizant, and EY.⁸ These firms recruit across all engineering branches, providing a standard entry-level salary baseline of INR 3.50 LPA to INR 5.50 LPA.⁴

Strategic Conclusions and Analytical Synthesis

An objective assessment of CUSAT's BTech placement architecture shows that while the university excels in niche fields, it remains vulnerable to technical sector hiring cycles and regional disparities across its campuses.⁴

- **The Specialization Premium:** CUSAT's overall BTech placement success is anchored by its niche programs.⁹ The high starting salaries in Safety and Fire Engineering (INR 6.00–7.50 LPA average)⁸ and Naval Architecture (INR 8.30–9.79 LPA average)⁹ act as a crucial offset against the more volatile circuit branches, which are highly sensitive to global IT market corrections.¹⁰
- **A Bifurcated Student Experience:** The substantial disparity in average salaries and placement rates between the main SOE Kochi campus and the CUCEK Kuttanad campus remains a key challenge.⁷ CUCEK students are often forced to settle for lower starting packages due to geographic isolation and a lack of specialized laboratory facilities.⁴
- **Reliance on Mass IT Recruiters:** While elite product-dev companies and PSUs offer high-value compensation packages (above INR 12.00 LPA), the vast majority of BTech students across core and circuit branches remain dependent on mass IT services recruitment.⁴ This dependency exposes the student body to broader macroeconomic cycles, as seen in the downward adjustment of the average package in 2025.⁶

To improve BTech placement outcomes and raise the average compensation profile, the university should consider several strategic interventions.

- **Upgrading CUCEK Infrastructure and Industry Integration:** The university administration should allocate developmental funds to improve laboratory and research infrastructure at the Kuttanad campus.⁴ Establishing dedicated corporate liaison offices in Pulinkunnu and facilitating joint recruitment drives with the Kochi campus will help reduce the employment gap between the two locations.⁷
- **Diversifying Core Engineering Placements:** To reduce reliance on IT service firms for core branches like Civil and Mechanical Engineering, the placement cell should build partnerships with infrastructure, automotive, and smart-manufacturing firms.⁴ This can be supported by offering electives in industrial automation, building information modeling (BIM), and electric vehicle (EV) technology.
- **Developing Niche Program Models:** CUSAT's success in Safety and Fire Engineering

and Naval Architecture highlights the value of specialized, industry-aligned curricula.⁹ The university could replicate this model by introducing specialized BTech tracks in clean energy safety, sustainable maritime engineering, and battery technology.

- **Expanding Global and PSU Partnerships:** Given the high salaries offered by PSUs and international maritime firms⁴, CUSAT should expand its public-sector and global shipyard recruitment networks. Aligning academic calendars with PSU recruitment cycles will help maximize these high-value placement opportunities.

Works cited

1. Principal's Message - School of Engineering , CUSAT, accessed on June 14, 2026, https://soe.cusat.ac.in/soe_message_principal.php
2. CUSAT Ranking 2026: Achieves 777th Global QS Sustainability Rank - FindMyCollege, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://findmycollege.com/colleges/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-ernakulam-47/ranking>
3. Achievements - Cochin University of Science and Technology, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://cusat.ac.in/achievements.php>
4. CUSAT Placement 2025: Highest Package, Average Package, Top ..., accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://collegedunia.com/university/25638-cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-kochi/placement>
5. I have chance to get an admission in cochin university of science and technology for m. Tech cse, A. I, Cyber security.. I don't know about the placements of this university, My intention is to get a good placement while studying.. So it is worth joining in cusat for m. Tech.... - Rediff Gurus, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://gurus.rediff.com/question/qdtl/career/chance-admission-cochin-university-science-technology-m-tech-cse-cyber/5229778>
6. CUSAT Kochi Placements 2026: Highest Package, Average Package, Top Recruiters, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://www.careers360.com/university/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-kochi/placement>
7. CUSAT Ranking 2026: Check Year-wise National Rankings Here - Collegedunia, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://collegedunia.com/university/25638-cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-kochi/ranking>
8. CUSAT Placement 2026: Expert Analysis on Job Opportunities at CUSAT - CollegePicker.in, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://www.collegepicker.in/blog/university/cusat-placement/>
9. Students of naval architecture and shipbuilding programme at Cusat secure top placements, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Kochi/students-of-naval-architecture-and-shipbuilding-programme-at-cusat-secure-top-placements/article68263467.ece>
10. CUSAT, Kochi Placements: Highest, Average Salary Package & Top ..., accessed on June 14, 2026,

- <https://www.shiksha.com/university/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-kochi-28013/placement>
11. CUSAT B.Tech Placement Statistics 2025 | PDF - Scribd, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://www.scribd.com/document/870278634/b-tech-2025-Placement-Statistics-Ksu-Cusat-Helpdesk>
 12. Placements & Recruiters - CUCEK - Cochin University College of Engineering Kuttanad, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://cucek.cusat.ac.in/placements.php>
 13. Cochin University of Science and Technology - [CUSAT], accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://suggestcollege.com/university/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat>
 14. B.Tech. in Marine Engineering at CUSAT: Placements, Fees, Admission & Eligibility, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://www.shiksha.com/university/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-kochi-28013/course-b-tech-in-marine-engineering-337254?scrollFeeDetails=true>
 15. CUSAT | Cutoff, Fees, Placements & Rankings 2026, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://jeecounselling.in/college/cusat-kochi>
 16. Department of Safety and Fire Engineering - School of Engineering , CUSAT, accessed on June 14, 2026, <https://soe.cusat.ac.in/divisions.php?dept=se>
 17. CUSAT Admission 2026 — Application Form, Eligibility, Dates & Process - EduNext, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://www.getedunext.com/college/cusat/admission>
 18. CUSAT Placement 2025: Highest Package, Average Package, Top Recruiters - Zollege, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://zollege.in/university/184959-cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-kochi/placement>
 19. Cusat students get 95% placement | Kochi News - The Times of India, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/kochi/cusat-students-get-95-placement/articleshow/110779952.cms>
 20. B.Tech. in Marine Engineering at CUSAT: Placements, Fees, Admission & Eligibility, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://www.shiksha.com/university/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-kochi-28013/course-b-tech-in-marine-engineering-337254>
 21. Central Placement Cell,CUSAT, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://cpo.cusat.ac.in/course-fulllist>
 22. Cochin University of Science and Technology- CUSAT Kochi Placements 2025: Highest Package, Average Salary & Top Recruiters - Times of College, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://timesofcollege.com/college/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-206159+placements>
 23. CUSAT Placements 2025: Highest Package, Average Salary, Top Recruiters - KollegeApply, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://www.kollegeapply.com/college/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology>

[-kochi-kochi-placement](#)

24. Cochin University of Science and Technology- CUSAT Kochi 2026– Courses, Admission, Fees, Placements, Ranking, Campus, Scholarships & Reviews - Times of College, accessed on June 14, 2026,
<https://timesofcollege.com/college/cochin-university-of-science-and-technology-cusat-206159>